



DOLINHANH BRIDAL · A GIFT FOR THE BRIDE

The Bride's

DRESS GUIDE

8 things every bride should know before deciding on her wedding dress. Read it before your first fitting.

DOLINHANH



DOLINHANH

TO THE BRIDE

Never choose a wedding dress just because “it’s beautiful”.

A dress can look beautiful in a photograph, on a mannequin, or on another bride. What matters is this: **is it truly beautiful on you?**

After years spent in the fitting room, we have learnt that most brides do not choose wrongly for want of beautiful dresses. They choose wrongly because they walk into the fitting without knowing what they are looking for, where to look, or what to ask before leaving a deposit.

This little book gathers exactly those things – eight sections, fifteen minutes to read, useful wherever you go to try dresses on.

Dolinhanh Bridal

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07	Questions to ask before you leave a deposit
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HOW TO USE THIS BOOK

Read it through once, just to get your eye in. Before the fitting, open sections 02 and 07 again and screenshot them onto your phone. During the fitting, tick the boxes as you go – by the end you will have enough to decide with, instead of deciding on a passing feeling.

03 Know yourself

Know your taste. Know your body. Know what makes you look your best. Before choosing a wedding dress, take a little time to understand the person who will wear it – you.

01 – Your taste	<i>“Which kind of beautiful do I actually love?”</i> Gather 5–10 photographs of dresses you love into one album, then look for what repeats – all full skirts, all lace, all off-shoulder? Look at your everyday wardrobe too: are you minimal or romantic, covered or sensual. The quiz overleaf will help you name your taste.
02 – Your body	<i>“What are my proportions?”</i> Stand in front of the mirror and compare three places: shoulders – waist – hips . No need to conclude yet – section 04 has a table of which figure suits which silhouette.
03 – Your best features	<i>“What do I want to show, and what do I want to balance?”</i> This is the what to show – what to soften question your stylist will certainly ask at the fitting.

A quiz to name your taste

Six questions – choose the answer most like you. Reading on a screen, tap this line to take the quiz and get your result straight away.

1. Open your everyday wardrobe – what is there most of?

- ☐ **A** Plain neutral pieces, very little pattern
- ☐ **B** Pretty dresses, statement details, a little sparkle
- ☐ **C** Small floral prints, soft fabrics that move
- ☐ **D** Body-skimming pieces that follow your curves

2. Which wedding photographs do you save on Pinterest and Instagram?

- ☐ **A** Korean brides, plain satin, minimal
- ☐ **B** A full skirt sweeping through a grand hall
- ☐ **C** A bride in a garden, tulle floating in the sun
- ☐ **D** A mermaid dress worn close, cut low at the back

3. Where does your dream wedding take place?

- ☐ **A** An intimate, warm, refined celebration
- ☐ **B** A large hotel ballroom, a glowing stage
- ☐ **C** Outdoors – a garden, the sea, sunset
- ☐ **D** An elegant evening dinner under warm light

4. What jewellery would you choose for the day?

- ☐ **A** Small pearls, or just a pair of earrings
- ☐ **B** A tiara and sparkling stones
- ☐ **C** Fresh flowers and fine tulle in your hair
- ☐ **D** One striking piece and nothing else

5. What would you love guests to say as you walk in?

- ☐ **A** “So elegant.”
- ☐ **B** “A real princess.”
- ☐ **C** “Like something out of a dream.”
- ☐ **D** “So alluring.”

6. What do you fear most about wearing a wedding dress?

- ☐ **A** Looking as if you tried too hard, not like yourself
- ☐ **B** Looking too plain, not enough splendour
- ☐ **C** Looking stiff, not romantic enough
- ☐ **D** Looking safe, like every other bride

COUNT WHICH LETTER YOU CHOSE MOST

Mostly A → **Elegant minimal** · B → **Splendid princess** · C → **Dreamy romantic** · D → **Modern sensual**
Two letters even? Then you are a blend of both – take both directions into the fitting. The next page describes each in detail.

Four kinds of bride we meet

Which way do you lean? Once you can name your taste, you will know which rail to start from when you walk into the fitting room.

Elegant minimal	Plain satin, a sheath or A-line with few details — the beauty is in the cut.
Splendid princess	A full ballgown skirt, sparkling beadwork, a long veil behind.
Dreamy romantic	Tulle and layers of organza light as cloud, fine sheer sleeves.
Modern sensual	A mermaid worn close, sheer lace, a low open back.

NOT BEING ABLE TO NAME YOUR STYLE IS PERFECTLY FINE

A great many brides only know what they want once they have tried a few dresses on. Bring the album you have gathered — your stylist will find what they have in common for you. That is what a bridal house is for.

06 What to prepare before the fitting

Prepare properly and one fitting will be worth three rushed ones.

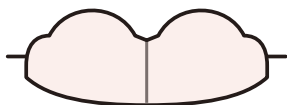
- ☐ Wear **a strapless bra** or a nude bodysuit, and briefs with no visible edge. Bust padding is usually already sewn into the dresses.
- ☐ Bring **your wedding shoes or a pair of the same height** so the length can be judged properly.
- ☐ Hair pinned or tied up, close to the way you plan to wear it on the day.
- ☐ Light make-up, **avoid a deep lipstick** – lipstick is what marks dresses most.
- ☐ Take off most jewellery and your watch, so the whole picture stays clean.
- ☐ Look through the catalogue first and **choose about 5 dresses** you like, then send the list ahead so they are hanging ready when you arrive.
- ☐ Come with **one or two people who genuinely understand your taste**. A large group usually leaves you more undecided.
- ☐ Come **once your wedding date is set** – only then can the dress be held and the alterations timed properly.
- ☐ Know the venue in advance: indoors or outdoors, a high stage or low, whether you will be moving about a lot.
- ☐ Have an answer ready for the most important question you will be asked: **what would you like to show, and what would you rather soften?**

HOW LONG A PROPER FITTING TAKES

About an hour and a half, and it should be private – one fitting room, one consultant with you throughout. If you have to wait, or share a mirror with other clients, the appointment will never be quiet enough for you to hear how you feel.

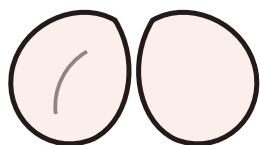
Underwear for a fitting

The question brides message us about most before a first fitting. The general rule: **nude**, **no straps**, **no heavy underwire**, **no visible edges**.



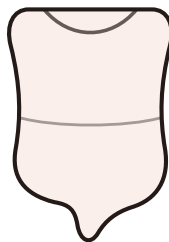
Strapless bra

In nude. The most useful of all – it works under almost every dress.



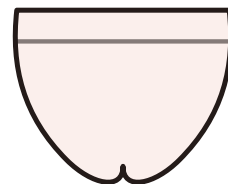
Stick-on bra

The easiest, since wedding dresses are often open at the back or shoulders. No wire, no straps.



Nude bodysuit

Lightly fitted, no wire. It supports the bust and smooths the waist, and stays comfortable all afternoon.



High-waisted briefs

Nude, with no lace edge. A high waist leaves no line under satin.

BETTER AVOIDED

✗ **A bra with straps, or a back strap**

Most wedding dresses are off-shoulder or open-backed – straps show and you cannot see the true shape.

✗ **A white bra**

White shows through fine tulle even more than nude does.

✗ **Heavy underwire, thick padding**

It changes the shape of the bust, so a dress made to those measurements will sit wrongly.

✗ **Thick lace briefs, low-rise**

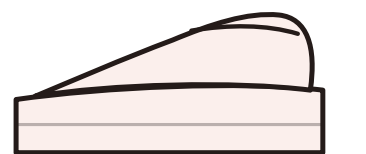
They press a line across the satin that shows clearly in photographs.

WEARING NOTHING IS FINE TOO

Most wedding dresses already have a supportive corset and bust padding sewn inside. Many brides wear only nude briefs — do say so to your consultant, there is nothing to feel awkward about.

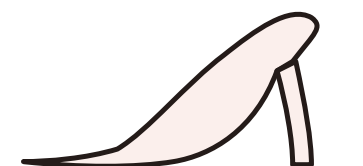
⚠ Three pairs worth bringing

The length of a dress is set to your height **in your shoes**. In flats the alterations will be wrong – in heels on the day the dress sits short or sweeps the floor. These three pairs cover everything.



Platforms

Level front and back. Hidden under a full skirt, and you can stand all evening without aching.



Heels

For dresses that show the leg: mermaid, a slit, a fitted shape. A 5–7cm heel flatters and still stands for hours.



Low shoes

A spare pair for the waiting room. Change when your feet tire – under a full skirt no one notices.

FOUR THINGS NOBODY WARNS YOU ABOUT

- ☐ **Put the dress and shoes on, then stand beside your groom** and look in the mirror together: are the skirt volume and the length balanced side by side? Too much volume leaves the groom lost in photographs.
- ☐ **Wear the shoes at home a few evenings** before the wedding. New shoes are stiff at the heel, and a full day in them will blister.
- ☐ **Put heel pads in beforehand, and carry plasters.** The rubbing usually starts after two hours of standing.
- ☐ **If you have not bought your wedding shoes yet**, bring a pair of the same height to the fitting. What matters is the height you will wear on the day.

WHAT HEEL HEIGHT IS RIGHT

Most brides choose 5 to 7 centimetres. Higher flatters the figure but aches after two hours of photographs; lower and the dress sweeps the ground. Outdoors or on grass, wear flatforms.



“Is there anything you love to show, or
anything you would rather soften a little?”

THE MOST IMPORTANT QUESTION IN A FITTING

10 How many dresses to try

Try too few and you have nothing to compare. Try too many and you will not remember the first one.

- ☐ Try all **four basic silhouettes** before settling on a direction: A-line, ballgown, mermaid and sheath.
- ☐ **Five is a good number.** Past ten it all blurs and tires you.
- ☐ Try at least **one dress you are sure will not suit you** – that is the one that surprises brides most.
- ☐ In every dress, **sit down, raise your arms, walk a few steps**, not just stand still in front of the mirror.
- ☐ Write one line about how it felt straight after each dress, before you try the next.
- ☐ **Ask your stylist for a short video of the front and the back** of every dress. The back is the part you cannot see yourself, and the part guests see most.
- ☐ Once you have tried them all, **keep exactly three** and try those again to decide.

HOW A FITTING IS ARRANGED

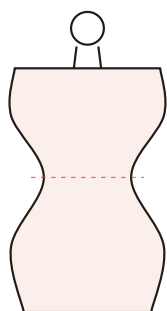
Into the dress → veil on → shape adjusted → first look & photographs → photographs edited
→ sent back to you

ASK FOR PHOTOGRAPHS, DON'T RELY ON THE MIRROR

A mirror flatters you; a photograph does not. For every dress, ask the studio to film the moment you first see yourself and to take a few frames. Look at them again that evening and you will see things you never noticed standing in the fitting room.

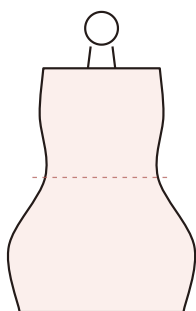
11 👤 Silhouettes that suit your figure

We choose by **proportion**, never by weight. First, look in the mirror and compare three places: **shoulders – waist – hips** – whichever is widest tells you your shape. No shape is better than another; there are only silhouettes that suit it better.



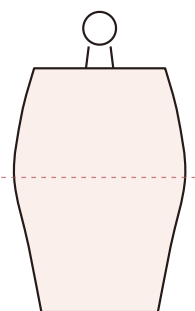
Hourglass

Shoulders and hips nearly equal, with a clearly defined waist.



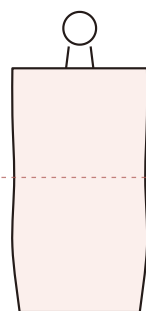
Pear

Hips and thighs fuller than the shoulders.



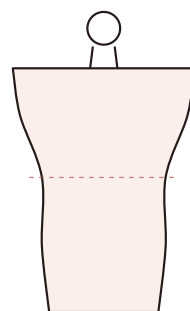
Apple

The waist is the fullest part, with slim legs.



Rectangle

Shoulders, waist and hips nearly equal, with few curves.



Broad shoulders

Shoulders and back wider than the hips.

IF YOU HESITATE BETWEEN TWO SHAPES

Choose the one that includes the part you would rather soften — a dress chosen that way is the safer bet. And at the fitting, your consultant will see it for you in thirty seconds.

A quick table for each concern

Now that you know your shape, look up what you would like handled gracefully – the next page draws each silhouette.

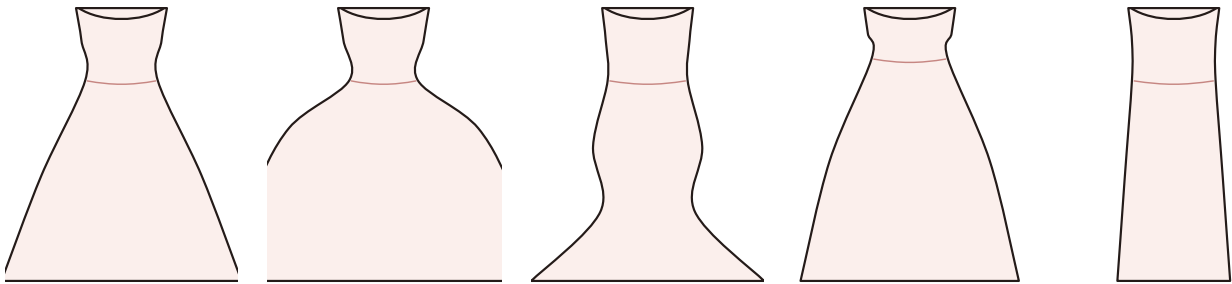
Fuller arms	Light puff sleeves, sheer tulle sleeves, an off-shoulder V – the shoulder line is drawn outwards, so the whole looks slimmer.
Smaller bust	A padded straight neckline, ruching at the bust, a square neck.
Fuller bust	A V neckline, wide straps that carry the shoulders.
Fuller hips	An A-line flaring from the waist. If you love a mermaid, choose one that flares from mid-thigh rather than the knee.
Petite figure	A high waist, a plain minimal skirt rather than layers of ruffles, a soft slit, moderate volume.
Marks or scars on the back	A sheer tulle back, lace across the back, or wide crossed straps.
Broad shoulders	A deep V, a soft off-shoulder, and avoid wide puff sleeves.
An undefined waist	An A-line or empire, gathered under the bust and falling softly. A narrow belt adds a point of interest; avoid stiff fabrics worn close.
A long body and shorter legs	Choose a high waist (empire) that lifts the gathering point – visually it lengthens the legs. Avoid a dropped waist.

PLEASE REMEMBER THIS

You do not need to lose weight, lighten your skin or change anything about yourself before walking into a fitting room. Finding the dress that suits you is our work.

⚠ Which figure suits which silhouette

There are five basic silhouettes. Knowing which to start from will halve the length of your fitting.



A-line

PEAR · APPLE

Fitted through the body, then flaring evenly from the waist – the kindest to hips and tummy.

Ballgown

RECTANGLE · BROAD SHOULDERS

The full skirt draws a waist and rebalances a figure with little natural definition.

Mermaid

HOURLGLASS

Close to the knee before it flares – it shows the curves in full.

Empire

APPLE

Gathered just under the bust and falling free – it softens the waist very naturally.

Sheath

HOURLGLASS · RECTANGLE

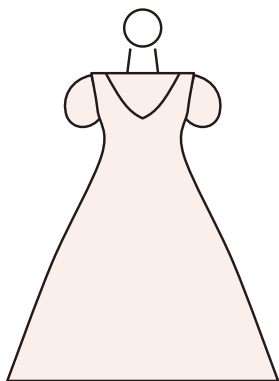
A straight, minimal, modern column – it shows every line.

TRY THEM IN THIS ORDER

Start with the silhouette that suits you best, then try one that goes against it, just to know. Many brides settle on the second dress – but only because the first one told them what they wanted.

⚠ Concerns above the waist — what to wear

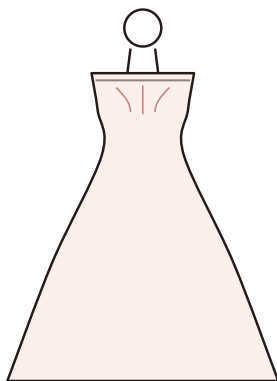
The four things brides message us about most, and the silhouette that answers each. Simply point at the right picture at your fitting and your consultant will understand at once.



Fuller arms

PUFF SLEEVES · OFF-SHOULDER

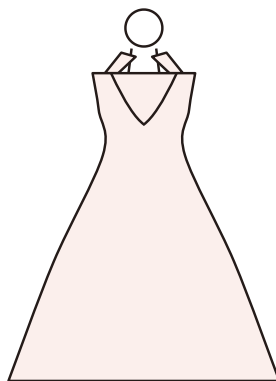
Sheer tulle or lightly puffed sleeves with an off-shoulder V. The shoulder line is drawn outwards, so the whole looks slimmer.



Smaller bust

STRAIGHT NECKLINE · RUCHING

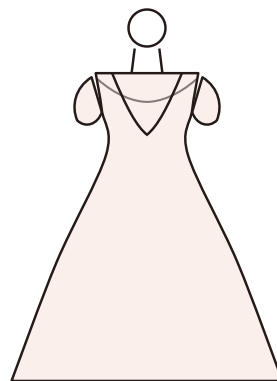
A padded straight neckline, a ruched or pleated bodice, a square neck. The bust looks full very naturally.



Fuller bust

V NECKLINE · WIDE STRAPS

An open V neckline with wide straps to carry the shoulders. Comfortable all evening, with no constant adjusting.



Broad shoulders

DEEP V · OFF-SHOULDER

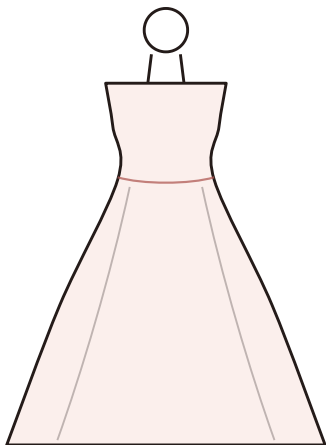
A deep V and a soft off-shoulder. Avoid wide puff sleeves, which only widen the shoulders further.

PLEASE REMEMBER THIS

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⚠ Concerns at the waist, hips and back — what to wear

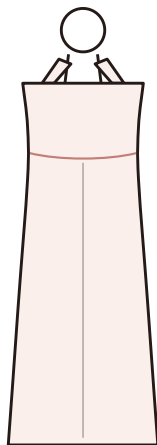
The remaining three. Almost everything you are worried about already has a silhouette designed to answer it.



Fuller hips

A-LINE FROM THE WAIST

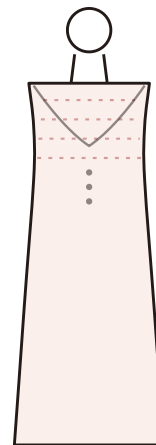
A skirt that flares straight from the waist. If you love a mermaid, choose one that opens from mid-thigh rather than at the knee.



Petite figure

HIGH WAIST · PLAIN SKIRT

A high waist, a plain minimal skirt, moderate volume, a soft slit. An unbroken vertical line lengthens the figure.



Marks or scars on the back

SHEER BACK · LACE

A sheer tulle back, lace across it, or wide crossed straps. Still a beautiful open back, with nothing to think about.

A SMALL TIP FOR THE FITTING

Photograph whichever picture on these two pages looks most like you and show it to your consultant at the very start. A picture always says it faster than words — and spares you having to describe what you feel shy about.

The secret of the lining colour

The lining is not only the ground of a dress, it is the secret behind its whole mood. On the same lace, changing the lining changes everything. The four shades Dolinhanh works with most:



White

Pure and traditional.

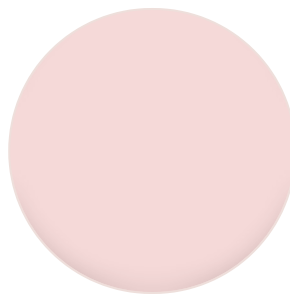
A pure white carries a beauty that is fresh, traditional and timeless.



Nude

Lifts the lace and gives depth.

A refined nude brings out the lace motifs, creating depth and harmony in the design.



Blush Pink

Sweet and feminine.

A soft blush brings a sweet, romantic, wholly feminine beauty.



Silver Grey

Luxurious and modern.

Silver grey is the modern, fashion-led, luxurious choice for a bride with her own character.

ONE QUESTION TO ASK AT THE FITTING

“Does this dress come in another lining colour?” — a great many brides love the shape but not quite the feeling, simply because they have not tried the lining that suits their skin. Put two shades side by side and photograph them in the same light; the difference reads far more clearly in a photograph than in a mirror.

EVERY SHADE, A DIFFERENT BEAUTY

Which lining suits your skin

The same lace dress gives four feelings on four skin tones. No lining is wrong – only untried against your skin. Where Dolinhanh begins:



Fair, pink skin

Cool tone



White and Blush Pink meet the pink in the skin and read very clear. For a modern touch, try Silver Grey.

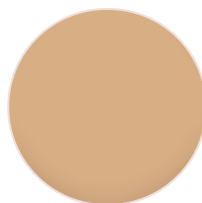


Fair, ivory skin

Warm tone



Nude shares the warmth of the skin, so it reads seamless and every lace motif stands out. Ivory white gives a gentle, classic look.

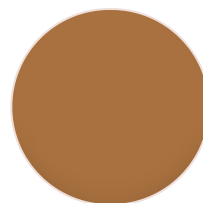


Golden brown skin

Warm, olive tone



Choose a nude about a shade deeper than the skin. Silver Grey against this skin looks strikingly modern.



Deep brown skin

Deep warm tone



A deep nude honours the lace completely. Pure white gives a clear contrast – one of the most photogenic pairings of all.

READING YOUR OWN SKIN TONE IN TEN SECONDS

In natural light, turn your wrist and look at the veins. If they read blue or purple – a cool tone, and White and Blush Pink will look very clear. If they read green, slightly olive – a warm tone, and Nude is the truest match. If you see both, you are neutral and every shade works.

THREE THINGS TO REMEMBER WHEN CHOOSING THE LINING

- ☐ **Look at it in the light of the party itself.** The warm light of a restaurant and the white light of a fitting room give different results.
- ☐ **Photograph it, don't only use the mirror.** Two shades side by side in the same light – a photograph shows the difference better than a mirror.
- ☐ **Try it wearing the make-up you plan to have.** Foundation usually reads a shade lighter than bare skin – enough to change the feeling of the whole dress.

18 ☆ Details on the dress to look at closely

Some things you never notice standing still in a mirror, yet feel very clearly after eight hours in the dress.

- ☐ **The corset line** – does it sit on your true waist, or is it riding above it.
- ☐ **The cups** – do they stay in place when you bend forward and raise your arms.
- ☐ **The skirt** – how heavy is it; will you be holding it up the whole time you walk.
- ☐ **The train** – how long is it, and is there a loop to gather it up for the reception.
- ☐ **The neckline and shoulders** – do they press or leave red marks after fifteen minutes.
- ☐ **The beadwork** – does it scratch your arms, or catch on the veil or your hair.
- ☐ **The lining** – is it dense enough when a flash fires from behind you.
- ☐ **Zip and covered buttons:** can you dress yourself, or will a second person always be needed.
- ☐ Whatever needs altering – write it down during the fitting, not once you are home.

ASK OUTRIGHT WHILE YOU ARE THERE

If you would like an added overskirt, an off-shoulder detail, gloves or a different veil, ask the price **during the fitting**. These are the easiest costs to run into, and the easiest to avoid – you only have to ask first.



Fabric decides how a dress falls, holds and moves on your body.

SECTION 06 · FABRIC

20 Fabric — four names worth knowing

Fabric decides how a dress falls, holds and moves on your body. Knowing these four names is enough to talk to any bridal house.



20

Lace

Romantic and classic.

Lace is the emblem of timeless romance, its motifs woven by skilled hands — but it is particular about skin tone, so try it in real light.



20

Tulle

Light as cloud.

Fine, delicate and floating, tulle builds those weightless layers. It softens the figure and moves beautifully on camera.



20

Satin

Luxurious and minimal.

A smooth, lustrous, supple surface that honours a minimal line. It sits close and shows the body — lovely for an indoor celebration.



20

Organza

Airy and modern.

Light and fine, yet full of structure. Right for a bride who wants volume without a heavy skirt, and right for outdoors.

FIVE THINGS TO CHECK WHILE IT IS ON YOU

- ☐ Look at the dress under **three kinds of light**: the fitting-room lights, daylight from a window, and your phone's flash.
- ☐ Sit down for two minutes and stand up again — does the fabric **crease and hold the crease** .
- ☐ Stand still for fifteen minutes — does it feel **hot, itchy or airless** .
- ☐ Feel the inside of the dress: is the layer against your skin rough.
- ☐ Walk a few steps and turn — does the dress move with you, or are you dragging it along.

WE CHOOSE NOT JUST THE FINEST FABRICS, BUT THE ONES THAT TELL YOUR STORY

21 Questions to ask before you leave a deposit

Ask everything before you pay, and there will be nothing to argue about later. A decent studio will answer each one straight.

- ☐ Is this dress **still free on my exact wedding date** ?
- ☐ Once I have paid, **can I change to another dress**, and at what point is it locked?
- ☐ If I **gain or lose weight** between now and the wedding, how will the dress be altered?
- ☐ **Alterations to my measurements** – how are they charged, and how far can they go?
- ☐ How many days do I **keep the dress**, counted from when, and what happens if I return it late?
- ☐ What accessories **come with the dress**, and how are an extra veil or a tiara charged?
- ☐ If the dress is stained or torn, **when do I have to pay for it** and what proportion?
- ☐ How long before the wedding do I come for a **final fitting**?
- ☐ On collection day, **who will fit the dress** on me?
- ☐ Are there **photographs or videos of the fitting** so I can check the dress when I collect it?
- ☐ If the wedding date moves, what happens to the deposit and the booking?

22 ♥ Not choosing a dress on a passing feeling

Feelings run high in a fitting room, and they are not always right. These seven lines will help you check calmly.

- ☐ **Don't settle on the first dress** that moves you. Set it aside and keep trying.
- ☐ **Sleep on it** and look at the photographs the next day, in daylight.
- ☐ Put the photographs of **your final three side by side**, cover the faces and look only at the shape.
- ☐ Ask yourself: could I **wear this for eight hours** ?
- ☐ Ask yourself: am I choosing it because **I love it**, or because the person with me does?
- ☐ Ask yourself: looking at the photographs **ten years from now** , will I still see myself?
- ☐ Still torn between two dresses: **choose the one you keep describing** to other people.

HOW YOU KNOW YOU HAVE FOUND THE DRESS

You stop asking everyone around you “does it look good?”. You look in the mirror and you already know the answer.

Choosing a dress in five steps

The whole book comes down to five steps. Take them in order and your fitting will be half as long, and you will still choose the right dress.

01 Read your figure

Stand in front of the mirror and compare three places: shoulders – waist – hips. Whichever is widest tells you your shape.

02 Choose the silhouette

Every figure has one or two safe silhouettes. Begin the fitting there, then try one that goes against it, just to know.

03 Try the fabric

In the same silhouette, changing the fabric changes everything. Lace, tulle, satin and organza give you four different women.

04 Settle the lining colour

The step almost nobody thinks about: the lining decides how the dress reads in photographs. Choose it for your skin.

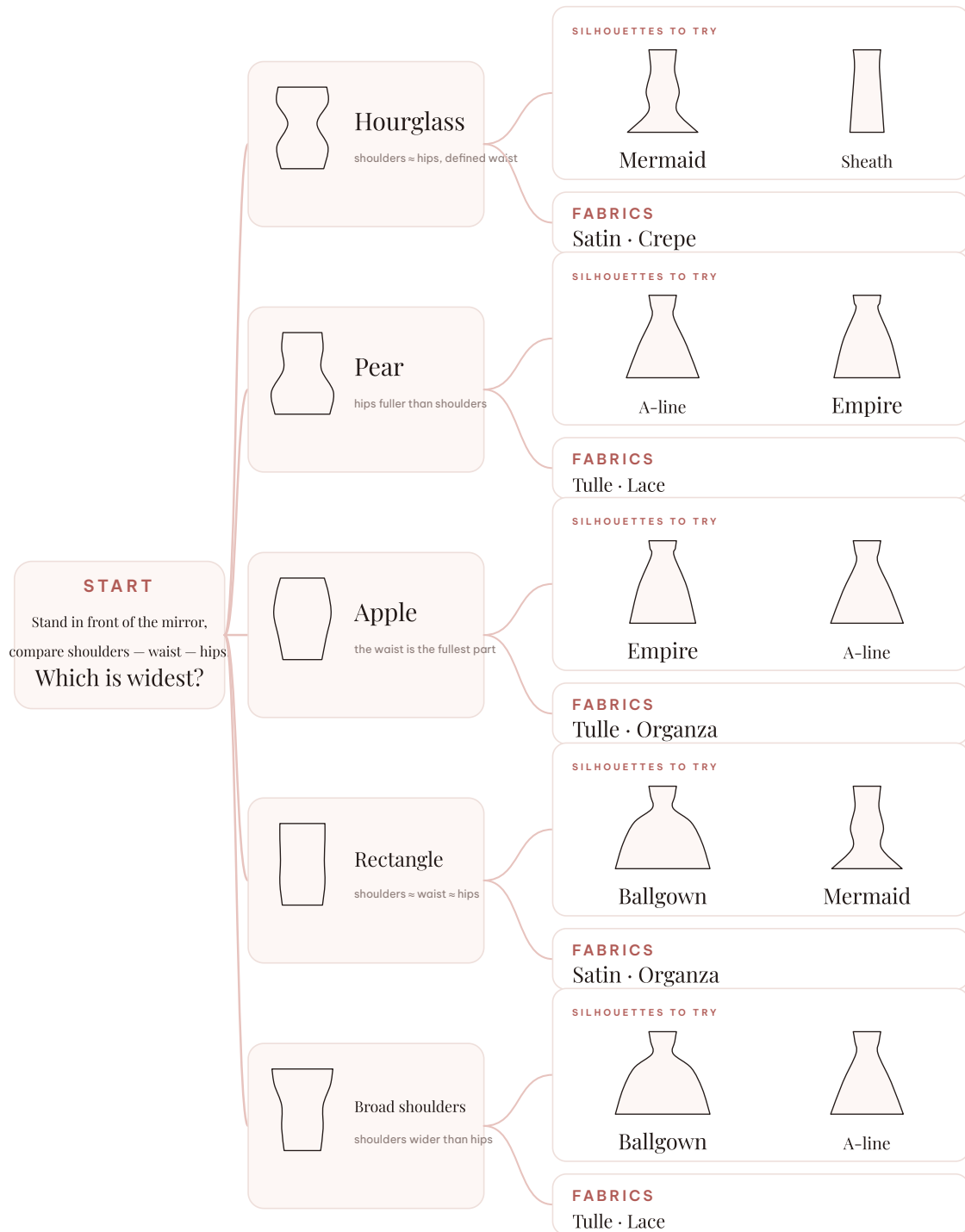
05 Choose the veil

A veil changes the whole picture, yet it is usually left to the last minute. A floor-sweeping veil for a formal ceremony, an elbow-length one for outdoors, a two-tier veil with a blusher for the family ceremony and for church. Try veils at the same appointment as the dress, and look in the mirror with it off as well.

OVERLEAF

The next page has the full chart: your figure leads straight to the silhouettes and fabrics to try. Photograph that page and take it with you.

Your figure — silhouette — fabric

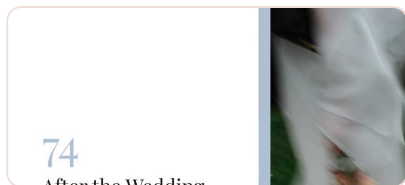
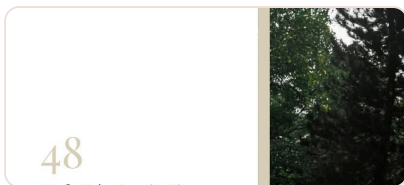
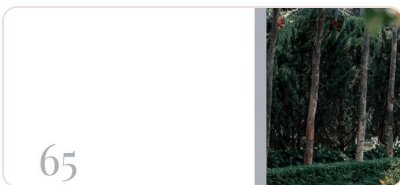


WHAT COMES NEXT

The Bride's Journey

The book you have just read is about **one dress**. This one walks with you **from the day you two decide to share a life to the day you become a bride** – eighty pages to write in, seven chapters, three layers.

- | | | | |
|----|--|----|--|
| 01 | Before becoming a bride – five conversations worth having before the wedding | 02 | Know yourself – a four-type quiz for both of you |
| 03 | Money – wedding money, a budget, no broken purse | 04 | Starting to prepare – two families, the ceremonies, the guest list |
| 05 | Becoming a bride – the whole business of choosing the dress | 06 | Bride Timeline – an hour-by-hour plan, an emergency bag |
| 07 | After the Wedding – living together, arguing, holding on to each other | | |



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- 3 **You receive** the 80-page PDF, a fill-in version for your phone, and the gift below

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A LAST WORD

“Yes. This is me.”

Dolinhanh believes a bride does not need a dress that makes everyone say “wow, what a beautiful dress”. She needs the dress that makes her look in the mirror and say the words above.

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